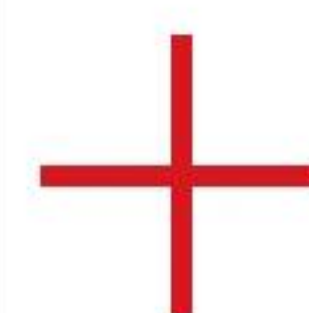




Did you know?

At UFC 37, Murilo Bustamante (pic, left) defended his middleweight title against Matt Lindland in one of the most controversial sequences in MMA history.

Early in the fight, Bustamante caught Lindland in a deep armbar. Lindland clearly tapped, and the referee stopped the contest.

However, Lindland immediately protested, claiming he hadn't submitted. In an unprecedented move, the referee restarted the bout.

Showing incredible composure, Bustamante didn't let the incident affect his focus. He simply outclassed Lindland again, finishing him with a guillotine choke in the third round. Bustamante remains the only fighter to "win" the same title fight twice in one night.

For Strickland to succeed, he must utilise his kicks and constant movement to reset the centre of the cage, preventing Hernandez from initiating the clinch, where his submission threat is most dangerous.

Bautista off to a winning start

UFC Vegas delivered a night of strategic finishes and major shifts in divisional rankings. In the main event, Mario Bautista passed his first headlining test by submitting Vinicius Oliveira with a second-round rear-naked choke. The victory extended Bautista's impressive run

and handed Oliveira his first loss in nearly four years.

The co-main event saw Kyoji Horiguchi continue his dominant return to the Octagon. Using superior striking to earn a unanimous decision over Amir Albazi, Horiguchi extended his overall winning streak to seven and immediately called for a flyweight title shot.

The heavyweight division produced a significant upset as unranked Rizvan Kuniev neutralised No. 6 Jailton Almeida. Kuniev's clinch control secured a unanimous decision, handing Almeida his

second consecutive defeat.

Meanwhile, Michal Oleksiejczuk survived a near-finish in the second round to outpoint Marc-Andre Barriault in a middleweight thriller.

Rounding out the card, Farid Basharat maintained his perfect record (15-0) with a gritty split-decision win over Jean Matsumoto, while Dustin Jacoby kicked off the main card by recording his third straight knockout, this time against Julius Walker. Jacoby capped his performance with a unique post-fight request: a chance to compete at a rumored White House event this June.